

Part 3B: Build with GitHub Copilot — Remote from Mobile

Video: Build ServiceNow Apps from Your Phone with GitHub Copilot

What if you could build a ServiceNow app from your couch, your commute, or a coffee shop — using just your phone? This guide shows you how to set up GitHub Copilot for remote development, add ServiceNow skills, and build the AI Agent Management System entirely from your mobile device.

Prerequisites

From Part 1, you should have:

- ■ VS Code installed on your computer
- ■ Node.js + NPM installed
- ■ ServiceNow SDK installed
- ■ A GitHub Pro account (required for Copilot CLI + remote features)

What We're Building (Same App)

AI Agent Management System — the same app from Parts 2–4:

Table	Key Fields
AI Agents	Name, Description, Status, Type, Owner, Connected CI (→ CMDB)
Agent Tools	Name, Description, Type (Tool/Sub-Agent), Parent Agent, Capabilities

The difference? We're building it from a phone.

Step 1: Get a GitHub Pro Account

GitHub Copilot requires a paid GitHub plan.

1. Go to <https://github.com/settings/billing>
2. Upgrade to **GitHub Pro** (\$4/month) or higher
3. Then enable **GitHub Copilot** in your account settings
4. Go to <https://github.com/settings/copilot>
5. Activate your Copilot subscription (\$10/month individual, free for students)

You need both: a Pro account + a Copilot subscription.

Step 2: Install GitHub Copilot CLI

On your computer (Mac or Windows), open your terminal:

```
npm install -g @github/copilot
```

Verify Installation

```
copilot --version
```

Authenticate

```
copilot auth login
```

Follow the browser prompt to sign in with your GitHub account.

Step 3: Add ServiceNow Skills to Copilot

This is the key step — we're teaching Copilot how to work with the ServiceNow SDK and Fluent API.

Run these commands in your terminal:

```
/plugin marketplace add servicenow/sdk
```

This adds the official ServiceNow SDK plugin from the marketplace.

```
/plugin install fluent@servicenow
```

This installs the Fluent API skill so Copilot understands ServiceNow table definitions, flows, business rules, and ACLs.

```
/restart
```

Restart Copilot to load the new skills.

Verify Skills Are Loaded

After restart, you can check that the plugins are active:

```
/plugins list
```

You should see `servicenow/sdk` and `fluent@servicenow` in the list.

Step 4: Set Up Remote Mode

This is where the magic happens — you connect your computer to GitHub Copilot's remote session so you can control it from your phone.

On Your Computer

1. Open your terminal
2. Navigate to your project folder (or create one):

```
mkdir ai-agent-manager-mobile && cd ai-agent-manager-mobile  
npx @servicenow/sdk init  
npm install
```

3. Start Copilot in remote mode:

```
/remote
```

This opens a remote session. Your computer is now a development server that your phone can connect to.

Important: Keep Your Computer Running

Your machine must stay on and connected to the internet for the entire remote session. If your computer goes to sleep or loses connection, the session ends.

Tips to keep it alive:

- Disable sleep mode while working
 - Keep the terminal window open (don't minimize)
 - Make sure your computer is plugged in
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Step 5: Connect from Your Phone

Install GitHub Copilot Mobile App

1. Download **GitHub Copilot** from the App Store (iOS) or Google Play (Android)

2. Sign in with the same GitHub account
3. The app will detect your active remote session

Open the Remote Session

1. Open the GitHub Copilot app on your phone
 2. You should see your active remote session listed
 3. Tap to connect
 4. You're now controlling your computer's development environment from your phone
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Step 6: Build the App from Your Phone

Now you're in a chat interface on your phone, connected to your computer. Every command you type runs on your machine.

Create the AI Agents Table

Type this in the Copilot mobile chat:

```
Create a ServiceNow Fluent API table for AI Agents.
```

```
File: src/fluent/tables/ai-agent.now.ts
```

```
Table name: x_vendor_aiagent_ai_agent
```

```
Label: AI Agent
```

```
Fields (prefix x_vendor_aiagent_):
```

- name: StringColumn, mandatory, maxLength 200
- description: StringColumn, maxLength 1000
- status: ChoiceColumn with active, inactive, development, retired. Default development
- agent_type: ChoiceColumn with autonomous, assisted, hybrid
- owner: ReferenceColumn to sys_user
- connected_ci: ReferenceColumn to cmdb_ci
- version: StringColumn, maxLength 50
- last_active: DateTimeColumn
- documentation_url: URLColumn

```
Use choices object syntax { key: { label } } not arrays. Export name must match table name.
```

Copilot will generate the file on your computer.

Create the Agent Tools Table

```
Create a second table for Agent Tools.
```

```
File: src/fluent/tables/agent-tool.now.ts
```

```
Table name: x_vendor_aiagent_agent_tool
```

Label: Agent Tool

```
Fields (prefix x_vendor_aiagent_):
- name: StringColumn, mandatory, maxLength 200
- description: StringColumn, maxLength 1000
- tool_type: ChoiceColumn with tool, sub_agent, api, plugin
- parent_agent: ReferenceColumn to x_vendor_aiagent_ai_agent, mandatory
- capabilities: StringColumn, maxLength 2000
- permissions: StringColumn, maxLength 500
- is_active: BooleanColumn
- execution_count: IntegerColumn
```

Add ACLs

Create ACLs for both tables.

File: src/fluent/acls/agent-acls.now.ts

```
Rules:
- admin: full CRUD on both tables
- itil: read and write
- authenticated users: read only
```

Build the App

Run this command: `now-sdk build`

If there are errors, Copilot will show you the output. Just tell it:

Fix the build errors and rebuild

Deploy

Run: `now-sdk install --auth mydev`

Step 7: Verify

Once deployed, open your ServiceNow instance on your phone's browser:

1. Go to your instance URL
2. Navigate to AI Agent Manager
3. Create a test record to verify everything works

You just built and deployed a ServiceNow app from your phone.

Complete Command Reference

Setup Commands (Run Once on Computer)

Step	Command
Install Copilot CLI	<code>npm install -g @github/copilot</code>
Authenticate	<code>copilot auth login</code>
Add ServiceNow SDK plugin	<code>/plugin marketplace add servicenow/sdk</code>
Install Fluent skill	<code>/plugin install fluent@servicenow</code>
Restart Copilot	<code>/restart</code>
Check plugins	<code>/plugins list</code>

Remote Session Commands

Step	Command
Start remote mode	<code>/remote</code>
End remote session	<code>/disconnect</code>

Development Commands (Run from Phone)

Step	Command
Scaffold new app	<code>npx @servicenow/sdk init</code>
Install dependencies	<code>npm install</code>
Build the app	<code>now-sdk build</code>
Deploy to instance	<code>now-sdk install --auth mydev</code>
Check build output	<code>now-sdk build --debug true</code>

Tips for Mobile Development

Writing Good Prompts on Mobile

Typing on a phone is slower, so make your prompts count:

- **Be specific upfront** — include file paths, table names, and field details in one message

- **Use short follow-ups** — "Add a priority field to the agents table" works great
- **Ask for reviews** — "Show me what's in src/fluent/tables/" to check the project state

When Things Go Wrong

Problem	What to Type
Build fails	"Show me the full error output and fix it"
Wrong scope prefix	"Update all files to use scope x_acme_aiagent"
Missing file	"Show me the project directory structure"
Need to undo	"Revert the last change to ai-agent.now.ts"
Session dropped	Go back to your computer, run <code>/remote</code> again, reconnect from phone

Best Practices

1. **Scaffold on your computer first** — run `npx @servicenow/sdk init` and `npm install` before going remote
2. **Keep prompts self-contained** — include all the details Copilot needs in each message
3. **Build frequently** — run `now-sdk build` after each table/file to catch errors early
4. **Save your session** — if you need to step away, keep your computer running

Why Build from Mobile?

This isn't just a gimmick. Real use cases:

- **On-call fixes** — you get an alert, you can push a quick fix from your phone
- **Idea capture** — you think of a new field or table while commuting, scaffold it immediately
- **Demo prep** — set up a demo app while traveling to a client meeting
- **Accessibility** — not everyone has a laptop at all times
- **Knowledge 2026 flex** — show people at the conference you can build ServiceNow apps from your phone

Summary

Step	What We Did
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1	Got GitHub Pro + Copilot subscription
2	Installed Copilot CLI on computer
3	Added ServiceNow SDK skills to Copilot
4	Started remote session with <code>/remote</code>
5	Connected from phone via Copilot mobile app
6	Built entire app (tables, ACLs) from phone
7	Deployed and verified from phone

You just built a production ServiceNow app from your phone. No laptop required (after initial setup).